is nothing a quiet *ghar wapsi* [reconversion to Hinduism] cannot solve when it comes to the building of a good dharmocracy.'[35]

The RSS's official understanding of Hindutva embraces this idea of Golwalkar's even today. In their reply to the tribunal constituted under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act 1967 to hear a case on the RSS in 1993, the RSS made an official statement as follows:

> The term Hindu in the conviction as well as in the constitution of the RSS is a cultural and civilisational concept and not a political or religious term. The term as a cultural concept will include and did always include all including Sikhs, Buddhists, and Jains. The cultural nationality of India, in the conviction of the RSS, is Hindu and it was inclusive of all who are born and who have adopted Bharat as their Motherland, including Muslims, Christians and Parsis. The answering association submit that it is not just a matter of RSS conviction, but a fact borne out by history that the Muslims, Christians and Parsis too are Hindus by culture although as [adherents of different] religions they are not so.[36]

This statement, of course, elides the 'holy land' problem in Savarkar's famous tripartite formula: if you are a Muslim, Christian or Parsi, however 'Hindu' you may be culturally, India is not your holy land. Hindutva acolytes gloss over this contradiction by suggesting that the key lies in these minorities acknowledging their foundational Hinduness: if they see themselves as 'Muhammadan Hindus', 'Christian Hindus' and 'Parsi Hindus', India can accept them. Since few, if any, of the believers in those faiths are ready to see themselves in those terms, of course, it is logical to assume they remain unwelcome in Hindutva-led India.

It is striking how Hindutva's acolytes share so much formally with twentieth-century Muslim modernists in South Asia and the Middle East: their conception of the glorious past, their imagining of a fallen intermediary time (blamed on internal cultural failings and rapacious outsiders), their stilted conception of culture and cultural difference, their negative appraisal of 'Western' values and 'Westernisation', and their fervent desire for the political unity of a religious community as the essential requirement for the attainment or re-establishment of national glory. Golwalkar's views of nationalism continue to inspire his political followers nearly half a century after his death—except that, unlike when he expressed them, those who believe such things now hold power in India and are in a position to do something about them.